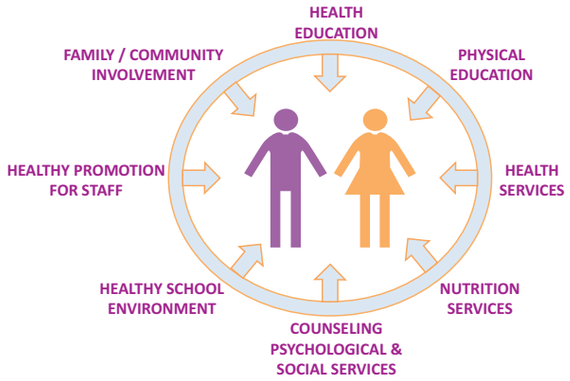
Scope of Sociology



4.2 Principles of Sociology

Hirschman's Principles of Sociology

- Things are real because they are socially constructed.
- Society is not just the aggregation of discrete, pre-existing individuals. That is, the individual is not ontologically prior to the social.
- The ideas we hold about the world change the world.
- The language we use to describe the world changes the world.
- Society cannot be understood by looking at individuals separately from their interconnections and their environments (both social and physical).
- The economy is not separate from the political or social world.

Nature of Sociology

- It is the science of society and studies organized in an organized society.
- It is a general science with all kind of social relationship.
- It is an analytical science.
- In sociologist point of view, man is a social animal.
- It has wider scope.
- It studies both conscious and unconscious activities of human being.

4.3 Importance of sociology in Nursing

Sociology plays an important role in the area of health sciences medicine and nursing with the common goal of preventing illness and restoration of health.

The study of sociology is important for nurses due to the following reasons

- Helps to understand those forces and pressures which affect patient adversely.
- It helps the nurses to understand the behaviour, conflicts, Inter Personal Relationship (IPR), hierarchy, groups and adaptation of different people working in hospitals.
- Through sociology, the nurse gets information about the socio cultural life of the patient.
- To study the structure of family, community and society.
- To understand the characteristics of social relationship, its complexities, and its impact on health care.
- Helps in the understanding and eradication of social problems.

4.4 Family

The family forms the basic unit of social organization and it is difficult to imagine how human society could function without it. The family has been seen as an universal social institution and it is an inevitable part of the society.

Definition

The family is a group of persons united by ties of marriage, blood or adoption constituting a single household interacting with each other in their respective social role of husband and wife, mother and father, brother and sister creating a common culture

-Burgess and Lock

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